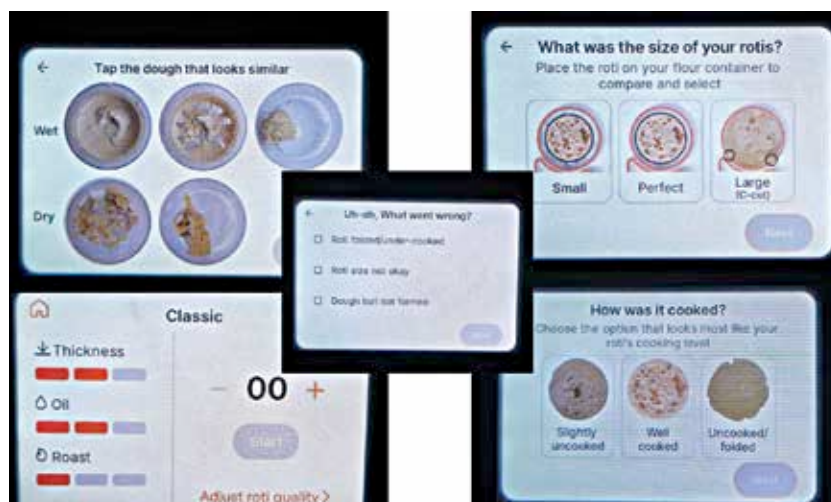




machine needing more water for my specific flour, I turned to a precise, user-friendly troubleshooting menu on the touchscreen called “Adjust Roti Quality.” This menu provides a visual feedback system that made it simple to guide the machine and help it understand my preferences. It’s like having a conversation with the machine about what a good roti should look and feel like.

1. **Roti folded/under-cooked:** I simply selected the visual that best matched my faulty roti, and the machine adjusted accordingly. For instance, my first few rotis were doughy and folded, a sign of being severely undercooked. I’d tap on the corresponding image, and the machine would immediately log that feedback, knowing to increase the cooking time or temperature for the next round.
2. **Roti Size not okay:** This menu offered options like “small,” “perfect,” and “large (C-cut).” While I initially faced the frustrating “C-cut” issue, where the roti edges were left uncooked, using this tool allowed me to quickly course-correct the machine’s pressing mechanism.
3. **Dough ball not formed:** This was my key to solving the uncooked roti problem. The machine was initially making dough balls that were too dry, which led to the uncooked rotis. I used this menu to manually adjust the water content with “Dry” and

“Wet” options, each with sub-options to fine-tune the dough consistency. I spent a week giving it constant feedback, and I even had to contact a tech person twice to figure out the exact settings. They confirmed my suspicions about the water content and guided me to the “Wet” setting.



## Form, function, and future

From a physical standpoint, the Rotimatic Next is a substantial piece of equipment. It’s heavy but can be moved around. All parts are detachable and can be washed normally, a definite plus in my book. However, even the cleaning process had its quirks; the machine one time reported that the cooking surface was blocked, even when it was completely spotless, which I found baffling.

The machine comes with a manual, a power cable, and a cleaning kit with

three different brushes. The app is essential for the initial setup and provides basic troubleshooting. However, many of the features promised, such as versatility for making bhakri, pizza bases, and tortillas, are currently listed as “coming soon.” Similarly, a much-anticipated remote functionality to start the machine from my phone is an update promised for the future. The “coming soon” list felt endless.

## Verdict

After a solid week of consistent adjustments and inputs, I started the machine one day, and the roti came out perfectly – fluffy, puffed up, and cooked evenly. Since then, the Rotimatic has consistently produced the roti I hoped for.

Given its price point, is the Rotimatic Next worth the investment? For an average Indian household, maybe. The initial week of effort is a small price to pay for the long-term benefit of perfectly cooked rotis on demand. I believe it



could find a valuable home in a more commercial setting, like cloud kitchens or small startup restaurants with limited space. For Indians living abroad, the Rotimatic is a good solution to having fresh, homemade rotis everyday.

The Rotimatic Next is a testament to kitchen automation. For those willing to invest a little time, it can be a genuine revolution in the kitchen. **d**

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